

MODULE 2

Claude's Toolkit

CORE For everyone · about 1 hour 20 min

02

MODULE 2 · WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO

By the end of this module

- Feed it files, choose the right model, and turn on the right tool
- Build a lasting Project with instructions and a knowledge base
- Build an Artifact, and set up Memory and a Style

LESSON 2.1 · 18 MIN

Make Claude more powerful

By the end of this lesson you will be able to:

- Pick the right model, and set the effort
- Turn on web search and research
- Connect your apps, and use skills

LESSON 2.1 · THE BASICS

What is a model, or an LLM?

- A **model** is the engine behind Claude, it writes the reply
- **LLM** means large language model, trained on huge amounts of text
- It predicts language, it does not look answers up

Claude is the app. The model is what is thinking underneath it.

LESSON 2.1 · YOUR MODEL

Pick the right model

When you need	Pick
Speed on a quick, simple task	Haiku
The everyday default, for most work	Sonnet
Deep reasoning on a hard problem	Opus
A large, long, multi-step project	Fable

Free gives lighter access to every model. Paid plans raise your usage limits and give priority access to Opus and Fable, for when a task is genuinely worth it, like carrying a multi-week research project end to end.

LESSON 2.1 · TOKENS

What is a token?

A **token** is a small chunk of text, roughly three quarters of a word. Claude reads and writes in tokens.

"Claude is helpful" splits into 4 tokens: Claude is help ful.

LESSON 2.1 · EFFORT

Set the effort

Effort is how hard the model thinks before it answers.

Effort	Good for	Example
Low, Medium	Quick, simple tasks	"Fix this typo"
High (default)	Most everyday work	"Draft a reply to this email"
Extra high, Max	Hard reasoning, slower but deeper	"Debug why this script fails"

More effort means more tokens spent thinking before you get a reply, so raise it only for problems that actually need the depth.

LESSON 2.1 · THE TOOLBOX

Turn on the right tool

A **tool** lets Claude step outside the chat to get what it does not already know.

Tool	Gives you
Web search	Current facts, with links you can check
Research	A deep, cited report from many sources

Research needs web search on, and is on the paid plans. For hard thinking with no web, just raise the effort.

DEMO

Connect your apps

Connectors let Claude use the tools you already work in.

- **Google Calendar** "what is on my calendar next week?"
- **Gmail** "draft a reply to the latest email from my client"
- **Notion or Drive** "find our pricing doc and summarise it"
- **Custom** wire up your own tool with a custom connector

You approve access when you connect an app, and Claude only sees what you can see. It still checks with you before doing anything that changes something.

LESSON 2.1 · SKILLS AND PLUGINS

Skills and plugins

- **Skills** reusable expertise Claude loads for a task. Ask for "a slide deck from this outline" and the built-in Slides skill fires automatically, same for Excel, Word, and PDFs. You can build your own for a workflow you repeat
- **Plugins** ready-made bundles of skills and connectors for a kind of work, like sales outreach or finance reporting

LESSON 2.1 · YOUR TURN

Try it yourself

YOUR TURN Turn on web search and ask Claude something that changed this week, then click a link to check it.

- Connect your calendar and ask what is coming up
- Ask for an Excel sheet or a slide deck
- Run Research for a short cited report
- Raise the effort on one hard question

Or try any tool on a task from your own week.